

Chandu Manjula — Portfolio Site Spec

A single-page, scroll-driven portfolio for a UI/UX & Product Designer, built as a static HTML file (Tailwind CSS via CDN + vanilla JS + GSAP/ScrollTrigger for scroll animation).

Stack & Setup

- Tailwind CSS via CDN (`cdn.tailwindcss.com`)
- GSAP 3.12.5 + ScrollTrigger via CDN (`cdnjs`), used only for the closing shot's pinned scroll sequence
- No build step — single self-contained `.html` file, images embedded as base64 data URIs
- Font: system (`'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif`) (mapped to Tailwind's `font-hn`)
- Document title: `Chandu – Manjula` (em dash)

Color System

Tailwind theme extension:

```
colors: { cream: '#141414', ink: '#D9D9D9' }
```

- Page background (`bg-ink`): light gray (`#D9D9D9`)
- Body text (`text-cream`): near-black (`#141414`)
- Note: token *names* are inherited from an earlier black-background version of the design and were never renamed — `cream` now means "foreground/dark text," `ink` now means "background/light." Don't be confused by the naming when reading the code.
- Accent red (used sparingly — dividers, CTA fill, hover states): (`#b3452e`)
- Closing shot section is a self-contained dark exception to the above — see below.

Layout Overview (top to bottom)

1. **Hero** — full-viewport, no scroll, marquee name + portrait
 2. **About** — one-paragraph bio, scroll-reveals in
 3. **Work** — two detailed case studies, alternating layout, scroll-reveals
 4. **Contact** — two-column premium card layout with CTA
 5. **Closing shot** — pinned, scroll-scrubbed two-frame cinematic sequence (the finale)
-

1. Hero Section

`relative h-[100dvh] w-full overflow-hidden` — single composition, no internal scroll.

Background: radial gradient, light gray tones (`□ #e2e2e2` → `□ #d9d9d9`), fades in on load (`anim-fade-in`, 1.2s).

Portrait: user's own photo (pencil-sketch style, transparent PNG cutout), centered on all breakpoints, `h-[80%] sm:h-[92%]`, bottom-anchored, slight grayscale/contrast filter (`duotone` class), soft bottom mask-fade so it blends into the background. Entrance: `anim-rise-in` (1.4s, `translateY+scale`, delay 300ms).

Marquee: giant scrolling name, two duplicated spans for seamless loop:

```
html
```

```
<span class="pr-[6vw]">Chandu&nbsp;&mdash;&nbsp;&nbsp;Manjula</span>
```

- Position: `top-[16vh] sm:top-[14vh]`, size `text-[16vh] sm:text-[26vh]`
- Animation: continuous `translateX(0)→translateX(-50%)`, 30s linear infinite
- Entrance: `anim-fade-up`, delay 500ms

Header (z-30):

- Left: brand "Chandu" (delay 800ms)
- Right (desktop only, `hidden sm:flex`): year "2026" (delay 900ms), nav column (Work/About/**Contact** — see popover below, staggered `1000+i80ms`), social column (*LinkedIn/Behance/Email*, staggered `1150+i80ms`)
- Mobile: hamburger icon only (3 bars → morphs to X), opens a right-side drawer

Contact nav popover: clicking "Contact" (desktop) doesn't scroll — it opens a small dark popover card below the nav with: email (click-to-copy, shows "Copied" feedback), LinkedIn, Behance, and a "See full contact section ↓" link. Closes on outside click.

Cream rule: horizontal line above footer, `scaleX(0)→1` from left, delay 1200ms.

Footer (z-30, raised above portrait):

- Left: "UI/UX Designer / End-to-end Product Craft / Editorial layouts, obsessively"
- Right: "Available for / Full-time roles & internships"
- A soft gradient scrim (`rgba(217,217,217,0.92)→transparent`), bottom 32-40 height) sits behind this footer, above the portrait, so text stays legible regardless of what's behind it in the photo.

Mobile drawer: right slide-in panel, `bg-[#141414]`, 600ms cubic-bezier, staggered link reveals (Site Index: Work/About/Contact at `text-4xl`; Find Me: LinkedIn/Behance/Email at `text-sm`), hamburger morphs to X, body scroll locked while open.

2. About Section

Simple, `(max-w-3xl)`, one label ("About") + one paragraph:

"I specialize in end-to-end web and mobile experiences — editorial web layouts, complex data systems, and task-focused mobile app interfaces, built in Figma from first sketch to shipped screen."

Wrapped in `(.reveal)` (fades + rises in on scroll via IntersectionObserver).

An animated **energy divider** (thin line, red gradient center, `(scaleX)` on scroll) follows this section.

3. Work Section — Case Studies

Two full-width alternating rows (`(grid sm:grid-cols-2)`, image/text swap sides between the two). Each is a `(.reveal)` + `(.case-card)` (lifts on hover).

Case 01 — Andhra Hidden Trails

- Tag: `(01 - Editorial · Web)`
- Two stacked images: home page + Gandikota destination detail page (grayscale, color on hover)
- Copy: editorial travel guide for six off-circuit places in Andhra Pradesh, framed as a field journal
- Facts: Role (UI/UX Design), Deliverable (Editorial web layout), Tools (Figma), Format (Field-journal microsite)
- Link: behance.net/chandu247

Case 02 — TravelCare

- Tag: `(02 - Mobile · Healthcare)`
- Two stacked images: onboarding screen + doctors-list screen
- Copy: healthcare app for travelers — verified doctors, transparent pricing, multi-language support
- Facts: Role, Deliverable (Mobile app, onboarding & core flows), Tools, Key features (verified doctors, clear pricing, multi-language)
- Link: behance.net/chandu247

Another energy divider follows before Contact.

4. Contact Section (Premium Card Layout)

`(grid lg:grid-cols-[1.15fr_1fr])` — two columns on desktop, stacked on mobile.

Left column:

- Live status badge: pulsing green dot + "Available for full-time roles & internships"
- Headline: "Let's work together." (text-5xl/7xl)
- Supporting line about what kind of work you're looking for
- Small divider + one-line location/remote note (desktop only)

Right column — the card:

- Bordered box (`border-cream/15`, `bg-cream/[0.03]`) with small L-shaped corner accents (top-left, bottom-right)
- Quick facts row (3 cols, each with a small line-icon): Based in (India, pin icon) / Responds in (24-48 hrs, clock icon) / Open to (Full-time & interns, briefcase icon)
- Primary CTA: bordered email button with envelope icon — on hover, a solid red (`#b3452e`) fill sweeps left-to-right, text brightens to light. Click copies email to clipboard, shows "Copied" feedback.
- Secondary row: two bordered buttons (LinkedIn, Behance) each with their real brand-colored logo mark (LinkedIn `#0A66C2`, Behance `#1769FF`), hover = lift + soft shadow + border brighten.

Background decoration: oversized faint "&" character, `rgba(20,18,16,0.05)`, top-right, hidden on mobile.

All elements are `.reveal` with staggered `transition-delay` (80ms, 160ms, 200ms, 240ms) so they cascade in on scroll rather than appearing at once.

5. Closing Shot — Pinned Two-Frame Sequence (the finale)

This is the most technically involved section — a GSAP ScrollTrigger-pinned sequence, **self-contained dark theme** (doesn't use the light `cream`/`ink` tokens; uses explicit hex colors instead).

```
html
```

```
<section id="closing" class="relative">
  <div class="h-screen w-full overflow-hidden bg-[#140f0d]">
```

- No manual height set on the outer `<section>` — GSAP's own pin-spacer controls scroll distance (`end: '+=200%'`, relative to viewport height). Setting both a manual height AND a GSAP end value caused a scroll-distance mismatch bug (blank gap) — don't reintroduce that.

- `ScrollTrigger.refresh()` called on `window.load` + two delayed safety calls (600ms, 1500ms), because the large embedded base64 images can finish laying out *after* initial script execution, which would otherwise make ScrollTrigger's scroll-distance math stale (Frame 2 would never fully complete).

Frame 1 (z-[1], bottom of stack)

- User-supplied composite artwork (`Highlight.jpg`) — giant wordmark, quote, and caption text baked into the image itself, NOT live DOM)
- `object-cover`, full bleed
- Starts blurred (`blur(14px) brightness(0.35) scale(1.04)`), sharpens to full clarity as you scroll into the pinned section (stage 1, timeline position 0→1)
- A dark radial "ember glow" veil sits above it, fading out as it sharpens
- Subtle film grain overlay (SVG `feTurbulence`, `mix-blend-mode: overlay`, ~6% opacity) + ambient "breathing" scale pulse (independent of scroll, infinite yoyo)

Frame 2 (z-[3], top of stack — must stay above Frame 1)

- User-supplied second image (a "Ferrari" lifestyle shot)
- **Critical: this frame's z-index must be higher than Frame 1's.** Frame 1 does NOT fade its own opacity to hide — it relies entirely on Frame 2 opaquely covering it. (Earlier version had this backwards, causing a permanent double-exposure ghosting artifact — ship it right the first time.)
- Reveal mechanic: starts at `scale(0.3)`, `opacity:0`, centered — grows outward from center to `scale(1)`, `opacity:1`, filling the frame completely (NOT a horizontal slide-in from the edge — that was an earlier iteration and was intentionally replaced with a center-scale reveal)
- Blur removes from 18px → 0px, brightness 0.5 → 1, simultaneously
- **Caption set baked as live DOM text on top of Frame 2** (since this image doesn't have text baked in like Frame 1 does), matching the same four-cluster layout as Frame 1's baked artwork:
 - Top-left: "Ideas / Designs / Experiences / Real impact" — **dark text** (`● #1a1210`), because that corner of the image is a light cream background
 - Top-right: "Same passion / A brighter / Tomorrow" — **light text** (`□ #f2efe8`), because that side is solid vivid red
 - Bottom-left: italic quote "Big dreams build reality." — dark text
 - Bottom-right: "Design / Build / Explore / Repeat" — light text
 - On mobile, bottom clusters need `bottom-40` (not `bottom-24`) to clear the functional row below them — mobile's functional row wraps to 3-4 lines and needs more clearance than desktop.

Functional row (z-10, always on top, pinned to bottom throughout)

Live DOM, not part of either image:

majulachand247@gmail.com LinkedIn Behance © 2026 Chandu Manjula

Stacks vertically on mobile (`flex-col`), horizontal on desktop.

What NOT to build (a real GrabCut/shader pipeline)

An earlier brief asked for actual subject-matting (GrabCut extraction of a person from a background image into a separate parallax layer, luminance-gated shader reveals, etc.). That's a legitimate offline image-processing pipeline (Python + OpenCV, or a custom WebGL shader) — **not something to fake or approximate as CSS**. What's built here is an honest, simpler CSS/JS equivalent: a pinned scroll section where one full image dissolves into sharpness and a second scales in over it. If true layer-separated compositing is ever wanted, that requires pre-processing the source images offline first and feeding the two resulting layers in as separate transparent assets.

Content Reference

- **Name:** Chandu Manjula
- **Role:** UI/UX & Product Designer
- **Email:** majulachand247@gmail.com
- **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/in/chandu-manjula-30a150433
- **Behance:** behance.net/chandu247
- **Availability:** Full-time roles & internships, India-based
- **Case study 1:** Andhra Hidden Trails (editorial travel web)
- **Case study 2:** TravelCare (healthcare mobile app)

Known Constraints / Lessons from This Build

1. **Copyright/IP:** never clone a third party's specific reference footage, artwork, or another designer's site pixel-for-pixel — adapt structure/technique, rebuild content from scratch with the actual user's assets.
2. **z-index correctness matters more than opacity tricks** for "one thing replaces another" reveals — get the stacking order right first.
3. **GSAP ScrollTrigger + manually-set element heights don't mix** — pick one source of truth for scroll distance.
4. **Always** `ScrollTrigger.refresh()` **after full page load** when a page has large embedded assets that affect layout height.

5. **Text color must be chosen per-background, not globally** — the same "cream" token can't serve both a dark hero photo and a bright red/cream studio shot; pick per-zone.
6. **Mobile spacing needs its own pass** — functional rows that wrap to more lines on narrow viewports need proportionally more clearance, not the same offset as desktop.